Bigfoot Walks into Town

By Chris Brock

INTRODUCTION

For decades, people around the world have been fascinated with the legend of Bigfoot, Sasquatch or whatever you choose to call it. Sightings of a furry, upright biped and reports of beastly footprints have been reported in American from Kentucky to the Pacific Northwest.

Is Bigfoot real? Nope, not going to answer that question. But one thing is for certain. If Bigfoot does exist, he definitely holds the title of Hide and Seek Champion of the World! But seriously . . . what would you do if one day, with no advance warning . . .

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NARRATOR: The Bigfoot wandered into Highville one fine summer morning and climbed a large maple tree in the village park. *(pantomime Bigfoot gazing over the town with a confused expression)* As the sun rose over the village in the foothills of the Adirondacks, Myron Jones, the owner of the Highville Diner, told the regulars who were buzzing about the unusual wildlife development that the creature looked lost. It just sat there in a notch

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of two big branches, gazing over the village like he (Myron was certain ***it*** was a ***he***) was trying to remember where he parked his car.

MYRON: *(speaks while he is scrambling eggs as if he is an expert)* It'll find his way home. They always do.

NARRATOR: Clifford Answorth, a regular customer of the diner, disagreed. Between sips of coffee, he said the beast wasn't lost but that it looked dangerous and theorized it was obviously planning an overthrow of the village. He also thought it purposely swam across the St. Lawrence River from Canada and came down the river valley to its current perch proving its insidious craftiness.

CLIFFORD: Just you wait. That thing has friends. You'd better lock your doors tonight.

NARRATOR: The Highville Police Department was dispatched to the scene and set up a command center in the shadow of the tree; and the whole park was shortly surrounded by yellow crime tape.

POLICE CHIEF MYERS: *(staring up at the creature)* Jeez, I didn't think Bigfoots were real. *(he reacts to a horrible smell)*

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NARRATOR: The first thing he noticed was the smell, and he recalled reading about a particular odor that was reported with Bigfoot sightings.

PATROLMAN WEST: *(takes a sip of coffee and opens his laptop)* I think it has something to do with what they eat. *(he rapidly types in some keywords to search for information, then reports eagerly)* Did you know they eat cows?

POLICE CHIEF MYERS: I don't care what they eat. Our first problem is getting it down. Maybe if he ate a crow or two, it would be a good thing.

PATROLMAN WEST: I said ***cows***, and we don't know for sure if it's a ***he***.

POLICE CHIEF MYERS: Whatever.

PATROLMAN WEST: *(still skimming the laptop article, amazed at the information)* And in Canada, Bigfoots are known to ride moose. It's how they migrate.

NARRATOR: Backed up by such expert knowledge, a half dozen officers approached the tree carefully, *(pantomime fearful officer approaching the tree)* looking up at each step, as if they were certain the Bigfoot was going to jump down onto them, like some sort of

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airborne Ninja. But fears passed as they got closer and . . . nothing happened.

PATROLMAN WEST: *(surprised)* He doesn't seem to be bothered by us.

POLICE CHIEF MYERS: *(retrieves his bullhorn and speaks into it, the words coming out seconds apart)* DO . . . YOU . . . KNOW . . . WHERE . . . YOU . . . ARE?!

BIGFOOT: *(lazily looks down at the officers)*

PATROLMAN WEST: *(laughing, maybe with a snort)* What? You expect him to understand English? And I think he'd know that he's obviously in a tree.

POLICE CHIEF MYERS: You're right *(embarrassed and befuddled; he thinks for a moment, scratches his head and has a brilliant idea)* Call the community college!

NARRATOR: *"Call the community college!"* was like the village of Highville's Bat Signal. It was reserved only for such special circumstances. Maybe the college had a Bigfoot expert who knew the language! *(Disappointed Wah, Wah, Wah)* [But] The closest they could find to a Bigfoot language linguist was a part-time anthropology professor who once studied the mating habits of Ugandan ostriches.

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POLICE CHIEF MYERS: Close enough!

NARRATOR: Before the professor was dispatched to the scene, the college's president hastily called a press conference.

COLLEGE PRESIDENT: *(grabbing a reporter's microphone she stares dramatically into the camera)* If the county gave us more money, we could afford to staff a Bigfoot expert. [Now] Our county, and perhaps our entire state, is in peril!

NARRATOR: But the anthropology professor, who was flown to the scene via the Highville Fire Department's helicopter, did have some useful information.

PROFESSOR: *(pompously lecturing the police)* Yes, this looks like a familiar case. Ostriches often will chase their prey into trees, hoping they will later expire. I suggest you wait it out.

POLICE CHIEF MYERS: *(waiting for more expert advice and reacting with intense nonverbal expressions when he realizes that none is forthcoming)* [Well,] that was the most useless advice I ever got.

NARRATOR: At noon, the fire department was called in. All were losing patience. It was obvious something had to

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be done soon, especially when politics entered the picture.

The local Democratic Party said the Bigfoot migration to the town was an effect of global warming. Meanwhile, the Republicans, despite obvious evidence to the contrary, declared the creature wasn't a Bigfoot at all, but rather a well-fed, inquisitive bear.

NARRATOR: The crowd was getting larger, and members of the media were now streaming the event live. Makeshift signs had appeared.

CROWD: *(chanting)* We Support Bigfoot! Health Care for Sasquatch! Don't Let a Liberal Bigfoot Loose! Bigfoot for Congress!

BIGFOOT: *(observes the chaos below like a casual observer, shaking its head and rolling its eyes, yawning and eventually nodding off to sleep. It is not impressed with the intelligence of the humans below)*

NARRATOR: It woke up when a ladder was slowly extended from a fire truck to the tree.

BIGFOOT: *(jolted awake; it appears angry. It breaks a stick from the tree and pounds on the ladder with it)*

NARRATOR: The sound echoed off nearby buildings.

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PATROLMAN WEST: *(in wonder)* That's how they communicate! I saw it on the Discovery Channel! I think he's calling other Bigfoots.

PROFESSOR: *(condescendingly)* The plural of Bigfoot is Bigfeet.

POLICE CHIEF MYERS: *(with false bravado)* I don't care what you call them. Let's end this now. Bring out the tranquilizer gun.

NARRATOR: Patrolman West radioed back to the station. The one remaining officer there said the tranquilizer gun wasn't available. Actually, the ***gun*** was available, but all the tranquilizer darts had been used up during crowd control at the County Fair.

POLICE CHIEF MYERS: Well, maybe we should just shoot the darn critter with a regular rifle. It's getting awfully late. And this crowd is getting too wild.

CROWD: *(chanting)* We Support Bigfoot! Health Care for Sasquatch!

NARRATOR: So, the village's dog control officer did the duty.

DOG CONTROL OFFICER: *(takes aim and fires one shot)*

(long beat)

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NARRATOR: As the sun set, a nearby roofing crew was available to retrieve the body. The roofers wanted to keep the Bigfoot, stuff it, and use it as a mascot that they could place in front yards at their projects. But Highville Mayor Charlie James consulted with Chief Myers.

MAYOR: I think we should bury it at sea like they did with Bin Laden.

POLICE CHIEF MYERS: Good idea. The last thing we need is a Bigfoot grave acting as an attraction for all sorts of loonies.

NARRATOR: Under the cover of darkness, the Bigfoot was wrapped in a tarp, loaded aboard the ferry that journeyed between Cape Vincent and Wolff Island, weighed down, and dumped overboard. The boat crew thought no one saw the dumping and gave each other high-fives. *(beat)* But on the shore, eyes peered out from the woods -- no one quite certain if they were of man -- or of beast.

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